

Little Hearts Learning Daycare

Parents Handbook

Welcome to Little Hearts Learning Daycare

Welcome to Little Hearts Learning Daycare! We are delighted that you have chosen us to partner with you in the care and early education of your child. We believe that the early years are a crucial time in a child's development, and we are committed to providing a safe, nurturing, and stimulating environment where every child can thrive.

This Parents Handbook has been created to provide you with a comprehensive understanding of our policies, procedures, and philosophy. It serves as a guide to ensure clear communication and a shared understanding of what you can expect from us, as well as what we expect from the families we serve. This handbook is designed to comply with California Code of Regulations, Title 22, governing child care facilities.

Contact Information

Facility Name	Little Hearts Learning Daycare
Owner / Director	Mina Sholihah
Phone Number	(559) 773-9472
Email Address	mina.sreeves@gmail.com
Physical Address	831 Tuscany Ct, Lemoore, CA 93235
Hours of Operation	Monday – Friday, 6:00 AM – 6:00 PM

1. Our Mission and Philosophy

Mission Statement

At Little Hearts Learning Daycare, we believe that every child's heart is a garden of potential. Our mission is to nurture these "little hearts" through compassionate care, curious exploration, and a love for learning. We are dedicated to providing a warm, secure, and stimulating

environment that supports the holistic development of every child, ensuring they feel loved, valued, and inspired to grow.

Philosophy

We believe in a play-based approach to learning, recognizing that children learn best when they are actively engaged and having fun. Our curriculum is designed to encourage curiosity, creativity, and independent thinking while teaching essential social skills such as sharing, empathy, and cooperation. We partner closely with families, because we know that a child thrives most when their home and daycare work together as one team.

2. Operating Information

Hours of Operation

Little Hearts Learning Daycare is open **Monday through Friday, 6:00 AM to 6:00 PM.**

Extended Hours, Holidays, and Weekends

We understand that families may have varying needs. We offer care on holidays and weekends as needed, with additional fees applied for these services. Please contact Director Mina Sholihah directly at (559) 773-9472 for availability and specific rates.

Holiday Closures

Standard closures (unless otherwise arranged as extended care) include:

- New Year's Day
 - Martin Luther King Jr. Day
 - Memorial Day
 - Independence Day
 - Labor Day
 - Thanksgiving Day and the day after
 - Christmas Eve and Christmas Day
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3. Enrollment and Tuition

Enrollment Process

In accordance with California law, we require a complete enrollment package before a child's first day, including:

- Child's Preadmission Health History (LIC 702)
- Emergency Information (LIC 700)
- Physician's Report (LIC 701)
- Immunization Records (Blue Card)
- Signed Parent Rights (LIC 995) and Personal Rights (LIC 613A)

Tuition and Fees

Little Hearts Learning Daycare offers a **single flat rate for all ages** (4 months – 10 years). Tuition is due every **Monday morning** before care begins.

Care Type	Rate
Full-Time Care (5 days/week)	\$245 per week
Part-Time Care (3 days/week)	\$175 per week
Drop-In Care	\$45 per day
Weekend Care	Available — additional fee applies
Holiday Care	Available with advance notice — pricing determined at that time
Enrollment Deposit	\$120 one-time fee (non-refundable; applied to first week's tuition)

Accepted Payment Methods

We accept the following forms of payment:

- **Zelle** — send to (559) 773-9472 or mina.sreeves@gmail.com
- **Venmo** — please ask the Director for the Venmo handle

- **Personal Check** — made payable to *Mina Sholihah / Little Hearts Learning Daycare*

A **\$120 non-refundable enrollment deposit** is required to secure your child's spot before their first day. This deposit is applied directly toward the first week's tuition.

Payment is due every Monday morning. A late payment fee may apply if payment is not received by end of day Monday.

Vacation and Absence Policy

To retain your child's spot in our program, **full tuition fees are required during periods of vacation, illness, or any other absence.** This policy ensures staffing continuity and the availability of your child's placement upon their return.

Late Pickup Fee

We understand that unexpected delays happen. However, out of respect for our staff, the following late pickup fees apply after 6:00 PM:

- **First 15 minutes late:** \$25.00
- **Every additional 10 minutes:** \$10.00

Repeated late pickups may result in a review of your enrollment agreement.

Withdrawal and Termination

- **Withdrawal:** Parents must provide a **two-week written notice** prior to withdrawing a child. Tuition continues to be owed during this notice period.
- **Termination:** We reserve the right to terminate care for non-payment, behavioral issues that pose a safety risk, or failure to comply with center policies.

4. Nutrition Policy

We believe that healthy bodies support healthy hearts. **Lunch and snacks are included in your weekly tuition rate — families do not need to pack a meal.** Little Hearts Learning Daycare provides the following daily:

- Morning Snack
- Balanced Lunch
- Afternoon Snack

Our meals meet USDA nutritional guidelines. If your child has specific dietary restrictions or allergies, please provide a medical note at enrollment. **We are a nut-aware facility.**

5. Health and Safety Policies

Illness Policy

To protect all children in our care, please keep your child home if they exhibit any of the following:

- Fever of 100.4°F or higher
- Vomiting or diarrhea
- Contagious rash or pink eye
- Any other symptoms of a communicable illness

Children must be **symptom-free for 24 hours without the use of fever-reducing medication** before returning to care.

Biting Policy

Biting is a developmental stage for some toddlers. If a bite occurs:

1. The bitten child is comforted and the wound is cleaned and assessed.
2. The biting child is redirected and taught appropriate ways to express their feelings.
3. Both families are notified via an incident report (the names of both children remain confidential).
4. If biting becomes persistent, a parent conference will be held to develop a care plan together.

Child Abuse Reporting

Under California Penal Code § 11165.7, all staff at Little Hearts Learning Daycare are **Mandated Reporters**. We are legally required to report any suspected child abuse or neglect to Child Protective Services immediately.

6. Emergency and Disaster Procedures

We maintain a comprehensive Emergency Disaster Plan (LIC 610) as required by California law.

Emergency Notification Procedure

In the event of any emergency, evacuation, or disaster, Little Hearts Learning Daycare will notify families using the following procedure:

1. **Immediate text message** will be sent to all emergency contacts on file with a brief description of the situation and any action required of parents.
2. If the situation requires, a **direct phone call** will follow to each family.
3. If we are unable to reach a parent, we will contact the **secondary emergency contact** listed on the child's enrollment form.
4. All communications will include the child's status and the location where children have been relocated, if applicable.

Parents are asked to keep their contact information current at all times. Please notify the Director immediately of any changes to phone numbers or emergency contacts.

Fire Safety

We conduct monthly fire drills. Evacuation routes are posted in every room. In the event of a fire, all children will be evacuated to the designated safe area and parents will be notified immediately via text and phone.

Earthquake Procedures

We practice "Drop, Cover, and Hold On" drills regularly. We maintain emergency food and water supplies for a minimum of 72 hours.

Disaster Evacuation

In the event of a required evacuation from the premises, our **primary relocation site is [To be determined — Director will notify families once a location is confirmed]**. Parents will be notified of the exact location via text message as soon as it is safe to do so. This information will be updated in the handbook and communicated to all enrolled families as soon as a location is finalized.

7. Communication and Parent Engagement

Parent Communication Policy

We value open, transparent communication with every family. We use the following channels to keep you informed and connected:

- **Text Message** — our primary method for daily updates, reminders, and urgent notifications. Please ensure your phone number on file is current and that you have text messaging enabled.
- **Email** — used for longer communications, documents, and written records. Please check your email regularly for newsletters and policy updates.
- **Brightwheel App** (*recommended*) — a free parent communication app that allows us to send daily photos, activity logs, meal reports, and messages directly to your phone. Ask the Director about setting up your account. We highly recommend this for staying connected to your child's day.
- **Open Door Policy** — parents are welcome to visit the center at any time during operating hours. We encourage family involvement and love when parents stop by.

Photo and Social Media Policy

We may take photos of children for classroom documentation or social media updates to share the joy of our daily activities. Please indicate your preference on the Media Release Form at enrollment:

- **Option A:** Permission granted for all uses (classroom and social media).
 - **Option B:** Permission granted for internal/classroom use only.
 - **Option C:** No photos permitted.
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8. Parents' Rights and Personal Rights

Parents' Rights (LIC 995)

As a parent in a California licensed facility, you have the right to:

- Enter and inspect the daycare at any time during operating hours without advance notice.
- Be informed of the name and contact information of the licensing agency.
- File a complaint with the licensing agency without fear of retaliation.

Personal Rights (LIC 613A)

Each child in our care has the right to be free from corporal punishment, humiliation, or mental abuse. No child shall be locked in any room, isolated in a harmful manner, or denied food or water as a form of discipline.

9. Acknowledgment Form

Please sign and return this page to the Director on or before your child's first day.

I, _____ (Parent/Guardian Name),
acknowledge that I have received, read, and understand the policies and procedures outlined in the **Little Hearts Learning Daycare Parents Handbook**, including the tuition and payment policies, vacation fee policy, late pickup fees, and emergency procedures. I agree to abide by these policies and understand that they are designed to comply with California State Laws and to ensure the safety and well-being of all children in our care.

Child's Name: _____

Parent/Guardian Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

Director Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

References

[1] California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 12 — Child Care Facility Licensing [2] California Mandated Reporter Requirements (AB 1207) [3] California Emergency Disaster Plan Requirements (LIC 610) [4] California Parents' Rights (LIC 995) [5] California Children's Personal Rights (LIC 613A)

Document prepared for Little Hearts Learning Daycare | Owner/Director: Mina Sholihah | (559) 773-9472 | mina.sreeves@gmail.com